FonectaGuard

PILOT AND CONTINUATION PLAN

Piloting the 24/7 guardian with Fonecta Connect

A 12-week season pilot on 1,000 Connect customers across Finland, Sweden and Norway, run as a randomised test, and a 12-month path from pilot to rollout.

47%
of the 2025 pilot's suggestions got no answer

65%
answered on WhatsApp, in a median 0.7 hours (e-mail: 40%, 16.7 hours)

1,000
businesses, 500 per arm, 1 Dec 2026 to 7 Jan 2027

+10 pts
response uplift the pilot is sized to detect

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One question, measured

In the 2025 pilot, owners trusted the suggestions: of those who answered, 88% accepted, 5% edited and 6% declined. The problem was reaching them: 47% never answered. FonectaGuard is built around that gap.

What we propose

- Run FonectaGuard on **1,000 Connect customers** in FI, SE and NO over Christmas to Epiphany 2026/27, the highest-stakes weeks of the year.
- Split them **at random into two arms**: the 2025 flow (one message on the preferred channel) against the guardian flow (message, reminder, voice note, and a call only when critical).
- Measure **more wrong hours fixed before the day**, with the owner always approving.

What Fonecta gets

- A measured uplift, or a clear no, in one season.
- A suggestion model validated on **real outcomes**, not synthetic labels.
- An operations playbook: consent, support queue, monitoring, kill switch.
- A go or no-go on a Connect-wide rollout, with evidence.

What we ask of Fonecta

Data
Yext Knowledge Graph read access and write access to the pilot entities

Consent
The pilot cohort, with contact details, channel preferences and opt-ins

People
A product owner, a privacy contact and a support lead for the review queue

Channels
A WhatsApp Business account and an SMS sender, or approval to use ours

Three decision gates

G1 · 4 Dec
Shadow-mode precision on real hours at least 0.80, privacy sign-off: go live

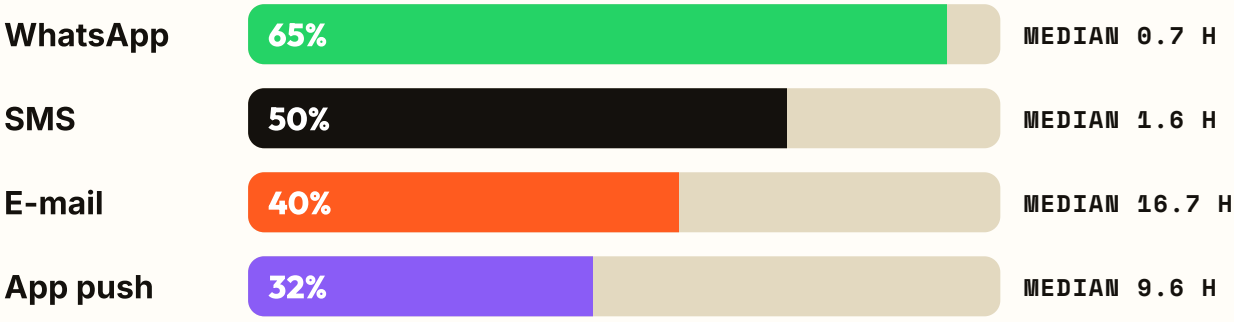
G2 · 18 Dec
Opt-outs under 1%, no incidents, uplift trending positive: continue

G3 · 29 Jan
Response up at least 10 points, precision holds: plan the rollout

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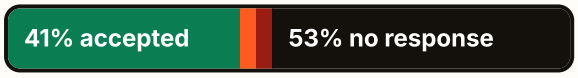
Owners trust it. Reaching them is the problem.

SHARE OF SUGGESTIONS ANSWERED, BY CHANNEL (2025 PILOT LOG: 761 BUSINESSES, 3,031 SUGGESTIONS)



The same suggestions, a four-fold spread in speed: a median 0.7 hours on WhatsApp against 16.7 hours by e-mail.

What happened to the 3,031 suggestions



Edited 2.5% · declined 3.0%. Of the owners who answered: 88% accepted, 5% edited, 6% declined.

The hypothesis

Going to the owner on the channel they answer, then escalating when a day is close and the stakes are real, lifts the share of suggestions answered from about **47% to 65% or more** without raising opt-outs or wrong suggestions.

Why not simply switch everyone to WhatsApp?

Only 18% of 2025 suggestions went by WhatsApp, because that is what owners had chosen. A one-channel rule would send people to a channel they did not opt into. The guardian flow keeps each owner's preferred channel as step one and adds the next steps only when the day is near. That is the claim the pilot tests.

Source: the organiser's 2025 pilot decision log, a synthetic stand-in for Fonecta's own. The first job of the pilot is to replace it with Fonecta's real numbers.

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A randomised test, not a demo

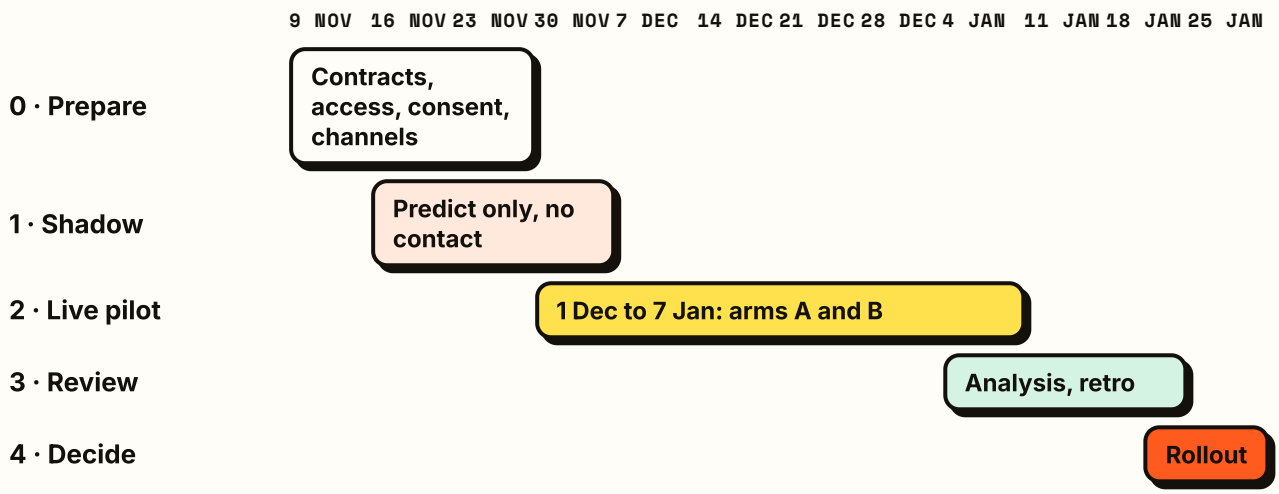
Population	1,000 Connect customers in FI, SE and NO, drawn from active Connect customers who have a mobile number and a channel preference. Proportional to Connect's market mix, stratified by segment, preferred channel and history depth.
Arms	**A · Control (500):** the 2025 flow: one bundled message on the preferred channel, no follow-up. **B · Guardian (500):** message on the preferred channel, reminder, voice note, and a call only when the day is critical.
Assignment	Random within strata, fixed before launch and published to Fonecta. Owners with an opt-out are excluded in both arms.
Power	500 per arm detects a 10-point rise in response (about 47% to 57%) with 80% power at the 5% level. We target 65%, so the margin is wide.
Special cohorts	**No history:** at least 15% of each arm, reported separately. **Autopilot:** owners who already hold standing permission, tier 0.95 and above only, in arm B. **Review queue:** days flagged as closed for good go to a Fonecta person, never to the owner.
Window	First message 14 days before each special day, from 1 Dec to 7 Jan: Independence Day (FI), Lucia (SE), Christmas Eve to Boxing Day, New Year's Eve and Day, Epiphany.

What the owner sees

One short message in their language: the day, what Google shows now, what we suggest, the reason in plain words and what a wrong hour costs. They answer with one word, a tap or a voice note. Nothing changes without their yes, every change has 24 hours of undo, and "STOP" ends all contact.

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From access to a decision in 12 weeks



Gates and days

G1 4 Dec go live · **G2** 18 Dec mid-pilot · **G3** 29 Jan decide
6 Dec Independence Day (FI) · 13 Dec Lucia (SE) · 24 to 26 Dec Christmas · 31 Dec and 1 Jan New Year · 6 Jan Epiphany

Weeks 1 to 3: prepare and shadow

- Agree data access, the cohort and randomisation, consent wording and the data processing terms.
- Connect the pilot entities to our Yext integration (read, write with read-back, undo).
- Set up a WhatsApp Business account with approved templates and an SMS sender.
- **Shadow mode** on 500 businesses: we predict the 2026 days but contact nobody, then compare with what owners actually enter.

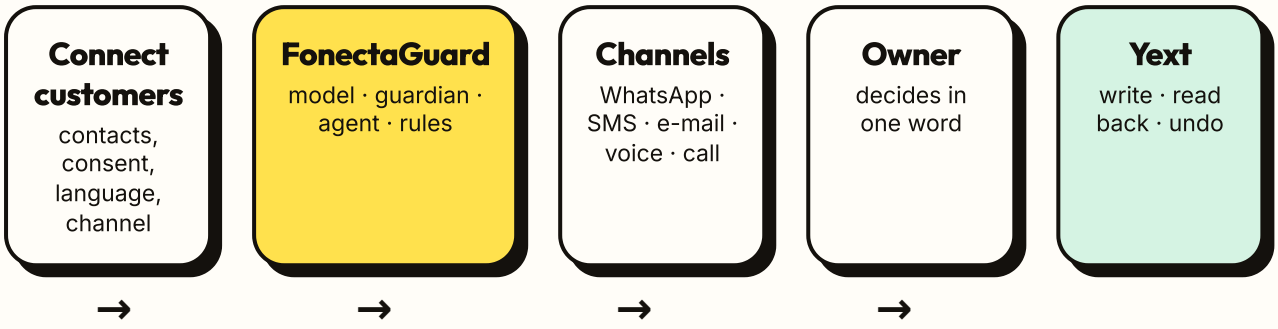
Weeks 4 to 9: live pilot

- Daily guardian run, a weekly review with Fonecta, and a shared dashboard.
- Fonecta support works the review queue within 48 hours.
- A kill switch per arm, per market and per channel, held jointly.
- G2 on 18 Dec checks opt-outs, incidents and the early response trend.

Dates assume a go decision the week of 9 November. If WhatsApp Business approval is not ready by 1 December, arm B starts on SMS and e-mail and WhatsApp joins when approved. Onboarding time with the provider is the largest schedule risk and is listed in the risks.

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Plugs into what Connect already has



Data in: exception-hour history (Yext holidayHours), Google user suggestions (Publisher Suggestions), listings, reviews and analytics, peer benchmarks, shopping-centre hours, local events and school breaks. **Out:** a verified change on the listing and an audit log of every contact and decision.

Who does what

Fonecta	Yext access to pilot entities; cohort, contacts and consent; WhatsApp Business account or sign-off to use ours; privacy review; product owner; support lead for the review queue.
FonectaGuard	The service and hosting; the suggestion model and its season retrain; the agent and owner rules; messaging and voice integrations; dashboards; weekly reports; the final analysis.
Jointly	Randomisation and metric definitions; gate decisions; the kill switch; the incident process; every message template and every wording.

Review queue

When reviews or Google edits suggest a business has closed for good while its listing is open, the owner is not contacted. A Fonecta person decides. The organiser's data has about 1.5% of businesses closing for good, so expect around 15 in a cohort of 1,000.

Already built and tested

Yext write with read-back and undo; WhatsApp, Telegram and e-mail delivery; opt-outs and quiet hours; the escalation policy; owner rules; signed webhooks; per-message capability links; an event log of every action.

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What counts as success

METRIC	BASELINE	TARGET	HOW IT IS JUDGED
Response rate	46.9%	**65% or more**	Arm B at least 10 points above arm A, p below 0.05 (G3)
Median time to decision	0.7 h (WhatsApp) to 16.7 h (e-mail)	**2 h or less overall, p90 24 h or less**	Reported by channel and arm
Decided before the day	not in the log	**90% or more of high-stake days**	High stake means 30 or more views that day last year
Suggestion precision (real outcomes)	0.86 on dev labels	**0.80 or more**	Shadow mode, G1; re-checked weekly
Accepted among responders	88%	**85% or more**	Quality guard: edits and declines must not rise
Opt-out rate	0.2%	**1% or less**	G2 and G3; any spike pauses the arm
Wrong-hour views corrected	not measured	**report per 1,000 businesses**	Approved days times last year's views, with confidence intervals
Cost per approved change	not measured	**report**	Messaging, voice, model and hosting, per approved change
Review queue age	n/a	**under 48 h**	Closed-for-good days handled by Fonecta staff

Baselines are from the 2025 pilot log. Targets are hypotheses we commit to report against honestly, including if they are missed. An arm-A result far from 47% would signal a data or process problem before anything else.

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Built to be trusted with a customer

Consent and privacy

Pilot cohort drawn from customers with recorded consent and a lawful basis agreed with Fonecta's privacy officer. Every message carries a STOP. Phone calls only for owners who opted in to calls. Data minimisation: we hold business facts and decisions, not unrelated personal data.

The owner decides

Nothing is written without a yes, except autopilot for owners who granted standing permission, at confidence 0.95 and above, with 24 hours of undo and a notice after the change.

Rules first

Owner rules (never close on Fridays, do not touch a date or a field) are checked in plain code before every send, apply and call. They cannot be overridden by a model.

Safe agent

The agent can only produce a fixed set of validated change types. Text in a photo or message is data, never a command. Every proposal is re-validated at apply time.

Contact limits

At most four days per message, quiet hours (no calls before 08:00 or after 20:00 local), at most one call per owner per day, no contact after an opt-out.

Security

Signed provider webhooks, per-message capability links, secrets held as encrypted worker secrets, an audit log of every contact and decision, and a kill switch per arm, market and channel.

Fonecta's privacy officer reviews the wording, the lawful basis and the data processing terms before any contact. Where a channel needs explicit opt-in (WhatsApp templates, calls), the cohort is limited to owners who have it.

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What could go wrong, and what we do about it

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	MITIGATION
Wrong suggestion reaches an owner	**Medium**	Tiers by confidence; low-confidence days become a question, not a guess; owner approves; undo; precision gate G1; weekly review
WhatsApp Business onboarding is late	**High**	Start application in week 1; arm B starts on SMS and e-mail if needed; WhatsApp joins on approval
Owner fatigue or opt-outs	**Medium**	Four days per message, quiet hours, reminders only for critical days, opt-out guardrail at 1% with auto-pause
Consent or lawful basis gap	**Medium**	Privacy review before contact; cohort limited to opted-in owners; calls only with explicit opt-in
Model weaker on real data than on the dev labels	**Medium**	Shadow mode and G1 before any contact; ask-tier for low confidence; report honestly and retrain
No history for new customers	**Medium**	Peer signal plus a question, not a guess; tracked as its own cohort
Provider or API outage	**Low**	Retries, per-channel fallback, read-back before confirming, manual override by Fonecta
Calls annoy owners	**Medium**	Only critical days, daytime, once a day, opt-in only; compared against no-call in analysis

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From pilot to Connect-wide rollout

Q1 2027

Analyse and decide

Pilot report, G3 decision. Productise inside Connect. Scale to about 10,000 customers for Easter (28 Mar).

Q2 2027

All three markets

Rollout across FI, SE and NO. Weekly AI-assistant audit and profile-gap radar for every customer. Mother's Day (9 May), Midsummer (25 Jun).

Q3 2027

Seasonal and drift

Seasonal closures and regular-hours drift for summer businesses. Review-driven closed-for-good with the review queue at scale.

Q4 2027

Full season

Photo, menu and price detectors on the same radar. Father's Day (14 Nov), Black Friday (26 Nov), Christmas 2027 on all customers.

Operating model

- Daily guardian run, a weekly ops review, a monthly business review with Fonecta.
- The model is retrained each season on realised outcomes; precision is tracked per market and segment.
- One on-call owner on each side, an incident process and a documented kill switch.
- Per-owner memory (edits, declines, closing-time habits) carries across seasons.

Commercial hypotheses to test

- **Retention:** guardian-enabled customers churn less.
- **Upsell:** a proactive tier beyond opening hours: listings, AI-assistant answers, profile gaps.
- **Efficiency:** fewer support contacts about wrong hours.
- Value metrics to price on: corrected days and wrong-hour views avoided. Pricing is set after the pilot, not before.

What the case looks like (illustrative, to be replaced by pilot data)

In the organiser's data, a business has about 163 views a season on days where Google is probably wrong. For 1,000 businesses at 85% precision that is about 139,000 views at risk. If 41% of suggestions are approved before the day (the 2025 flow) about 57,000 views are corrected; at 57% (the guardian target) about 79,000. The difference is about **22,000 people per 1,000 businesses per season**, or about 2.2 million across 100,000 customers. This is synthetic-data arithmetic: the pilot exists to turn it into measured numbers.

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The first three weeks

WEEK 1	Name the product owner and privacy contact. Agree the cohort criteria and the consent route. Start the WhatsApp Business application.
WEEK 1	Grant access to the pilot entities in Yext and share the customer contact and consent fields for the cohort.
WEEK 2	Sign off message templates in all four languages. Agree the data processing terms and the kill-switch contacts.
WEEK 3	Randomise and freeze the cohort. Begin shadow mode. Share the dashboard.

We deliver

- The service, hosting and 24/7 guardian for the pilot cohort.
- A weekly report and a shared live dashboard.
- The pilot report with the raw decision log, the analysis code and a recommendation.
- A rollout plan and an estimate of run costs from measured numbers.

We need

- A go decision on the cohort and the window.
- The access, consent and channel items above.
- One decision-maker at Fonecta available for the three gates.

What exists today

A working prototype: a suggestion model scoring 63.6 against a 54.5 baseline out of fold, a real Yext sandbox write with read-back and undo, WhatsApp, Telegram and e-mail delivery, a general agent with photo, voice and text, owner rules and an escalation policy, with 133 automated tests. Live at fonectaguard.arcumet.com; the code and README are in the submission.

Assumptions and limits

Where the numbers come from

- Baselines come from the organiser's 2025 pilot log and customer file: 761 businesses, 3,031 suggestions, 3,031 contacts. They are synthetic stand-ins for Fonecta's own data.
- The model score is out of fold on the dev labels with the organiser's scoring rules ported; the hidden test score may differ.
- The 14 million and 22,000 figures are extrapolations from synthetic data.

What the pilot will prove

- The model on Fonecta's real exception history and real owners.
- The phone-call step at scale: it is built and covered by automated tests, and goes live with a telephony number.
- Photo, phone-number and address changes on real data: they are validated and tested, and the pilot scores them against real outcomes.

Sample size

$n = 2\,(1.96 + 0.84)^2\,p(1 - p) / d^2$ with $p = 0.52$ and $d = 0.10$ gives about 391 per arm. We use 500 to allow for exclusions and for the no-history cohort.

Contact

FonectaGuard team, Since AI Hackathon 2026, Turku.
Live demo and control room: fonectaguard.arcumet.com
Code, README and predictions file: in the submission.